

LOW CODE

EXPERIMENT - 2

Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

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AIM

To set up a Zoho Creator account, create and explore a sample application using forms, reports and dashboards, and understand the basic platform architecture and the Develop, Deploy and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator interface.

SETTING UP ZOHO CREATOR

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code application development platform. Applications can be created through a browser using visual development tools, without requiring large amounts of manual programming.

I) Create the Sample Application

1. Open the Zoho Creator website and sign in using a Zoho account. If you do not have an account, create a Zoho account and then open Zoho Creator.
2. From the Creator home page, select the option to create a new solution/application.
3. Choose Applications and select Create from Scratch.
4. Enter a suitable application name, such as “CORPORATE ASSET MAINTENANCE”, and create the application.
5. The application design window opens. From here, components such as Forms, Reports, Pages and Workflows can be added and configured.
6. For this experiment, create a simple Student Management System containing a Student Details form, a Student Report and a Student Dashboard.

Creating a Form

A form is used to collect and store data from users. In Zoho Creator, forms are one of the main components of an application. Create the Student Details form and add fields such as Student Name, Register Number, Department, Email and Phone Number.

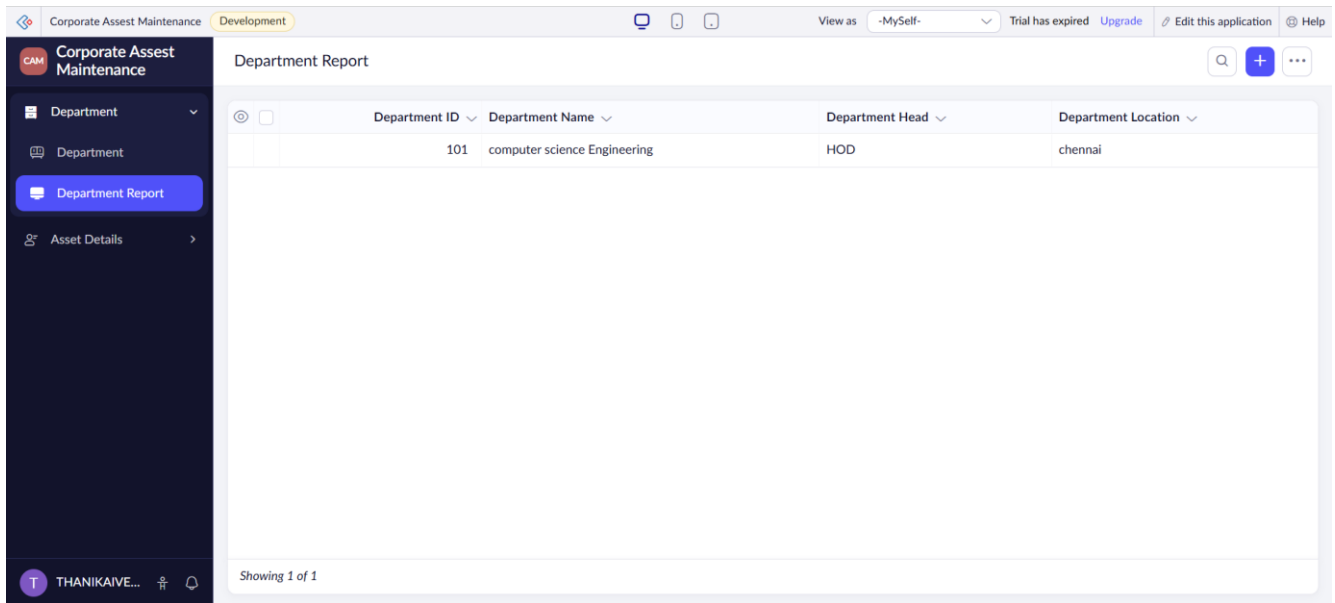
7. Open the application in edit/design mode.
8. Click the + (Add) option and select Form.
9. Choose From Scratch and enter the form name as “Student Details”.
10. Drag and drop the required fields into the form builder.
11. Configure the field properties and save the form.
12. Open the form in live mode and enter a few sample student records.

The screenshot shows a form builder interface for 'Corporate Asset Maintenance Department'. On the left, a 'Basic Fields' panel contains icons for Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, and Drop Down. The main workspace shows a form with four fields: 'Department ID' (highlighted with a blue border), 'Department Name', 'Department Head', and 'Department Location'. A right-hand panel titled 'Field Properties' is open for the 'Department ID' field. It includes fields for 'Field name' (Department ID), 'Field link name' (Department_ID), 'Display format' (Default), 'Validation' (Mandatory and No duplicate values checkboxes), 'Initial value' (Initial value), and 'Max Digits' (10). A 'Done' button is located in the top right corner of the interface.

Creating a Report

A report displays the data collected through a form in a meaningful format. A list report is normally created automatically when a form is created, and additional reports can be customized according to the application's requirements.

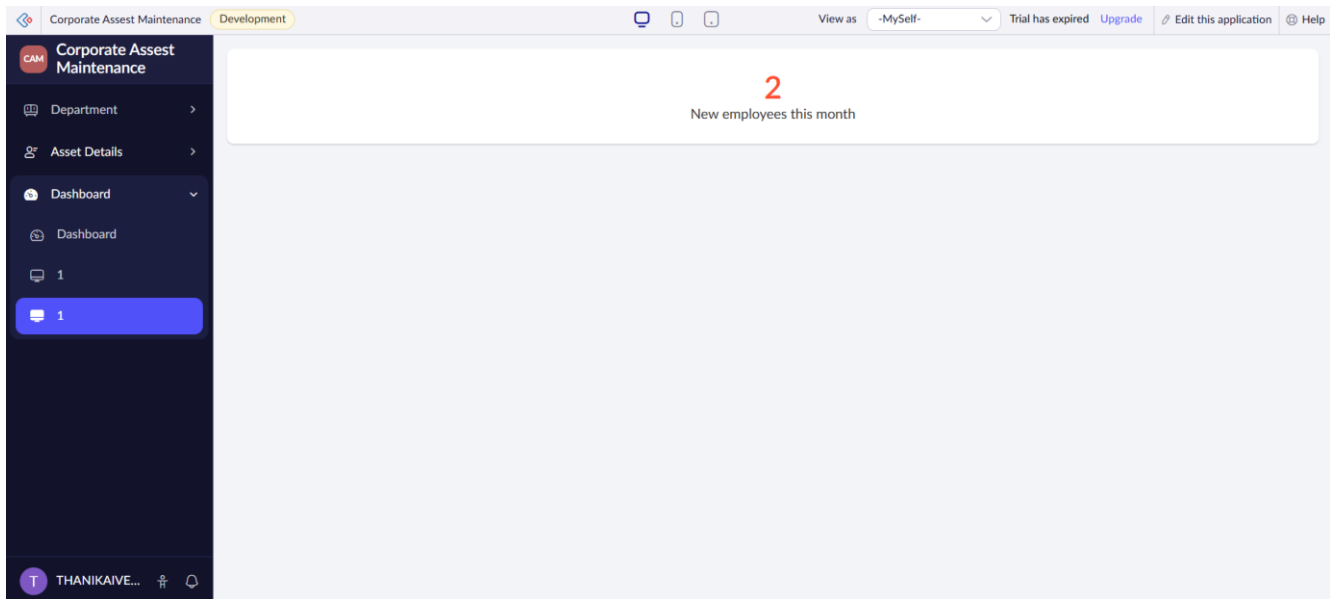
13. Open the application design page.
14. Select the option to add a new Report, if a separate report is required.
15. Choose the Student Details form as the data source.
16. Select a suitable report type, such as List.
17. Name the report “Student Report”.
18. Configure sorting, filtering or grouping if required and save the report.



Creating a Dashboard

A dashboard provides a visual summary of application information. It can be used to display important metrics and visual components in one place. For this experiment, create a Student Dashboard and add suitable reports or visual components.

19. Open the application/page builder and create or open the required dashboard/page area.
20. Name the dashboard “Student Dashboard”.
21. Add suitable report or visual components based on the Student Details data.
22. Arrange the components using the visual/drag-and-drop interface.
23. Save and preview the dashboard to verify that the information is displayed correctly.



Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Zoho Creator provides a browser-based low-code development environment in which applications are designed using visual components. The platform supports application development, testing and deployment, while application settings, users, environments and other configurations can be managed from the platform interface.

Develop

- The Develop section is used to create and modify applications and their components.
- Developers can work with forms, reports, pages, workflows and other visual components.
- It provides the main design environment for building and customizing application functionality.

Deploy

- The Deploy section is used to make applications available to users and manage deployment-related features.
- Creator supports controlled development, staging and production flows when environments are enabled.
- Deployment options can include publishing applications and configuring access through portals or other deployment features.

Manage

- The Manage area is used to control application settings, users, permissions and other administrative configurations.

- Administrators can manage application details, users, access options and environments according to their permissions.
- It helps maintain and control the application after it has been created and deployed.

RESULT

The Zoho Creator account and sample Student Management System application were successfully set up and explored. A form was created to collect student data, a report was used to display the collected data, and a dashboard was created to provide a visual summary. The Develop, Deploy and Manage sections of the Zoho Creator platform were also studied.